Personal Details of 40,000 Homeland Security Workers Appear Online

From: CBC World Mined: 2026-10-29 3 min read

A website that shares leaked documents said on Wednesday that it had published personal details of more than 40,000 people who work for the U.S. Department of Homeland Security, known as DHS, which handles border security and disaster response. The shared data includes names, phone numbers, email addresses, and job titles from DHS agencies. Some job titles revealed sensitive assignments in special operations, **surveillance**, **computer forensics**, and **undercover work**. Distributed Denial of Secrets, the group behind the release, said the information came from an entity calling itself the Department of Peace, and that the data was harvested from the Okta sign-on service used by DHS. Okta said it is secure and has no evidence its data or systems were **compromised**. DHS said it was aware of a **breach** and was working to address it and protect its employees. Reuters said it could not verify the entire trove, but it matched details about six employees to credit bureau records and confirmed three employees' phone numbers by calling them. This is the third government data leak in the past month.

Word Treasure

surveillance -- Surveillance means watching people or places closely, often to gather information.

computer forensics -- Computer forensics is the work of finding clues in computers and digital files.

undercover work -- Undercover work is secret work done while hiding who you really are.

breach -- A breach is when private information is taken or shared without permission.

compromised -- If a system is compromised, someone has broken into it or weakened its safety.

Background you need

The Department of Homeland Security is a part of the United States government that handles border security and disaster response.

A sign-on service lets workers log in once to reach many work systems.

When private details are shared online, workers can be at risk, so the department works to protect its employees.

Break it down

WHO: Distributed Denial of Secrets, DHS workers, Okta, and Reuters
WHAT: Personal details of DHS workers were published online after a data leak
WHERE: Online, in data harvested from the Okta sign-on service used by DHS
WHY: The information came from an entity calling itself the Department of Peace and was shared through a leaked-documents website

Why it matters

Keeping passwords and personal details private matters because sharing them online can put people at risk, just like keeping your own login details secret at school.

Test what you remember

1. Whose personal details were published online?

(A) People who work for the U.S. Department of Homeland Security
(B) Workers at a phone company
(C) Students at a school
(D) Visitors to a museum

2. What kind of information was shared?

(A) Names, phone numbers, email addresses, and job titles
(B) Recipes and menus
(C) Train times and ticket prices
(D) School grades and test scores

3. Which group was behind the release?

(A) Okta
(B) Reuters
(C) Distributed Denial of Secrets
(D) The Department of Peace

4. What did Okta say about its systems?

(A) They were sold to another company
(B) They were never used by DHS
(C) They are secure and it has no evidence its data or systems were compromised
(D) They were shut down for repairs

5. What did DHS say it was doing?

(A) Closing all its offices
(B) Changing its name
(C) Working to address the breach and protect its employees
(D) Ignoring the problem

6. Which of these was one of the sensitive assignments revealed by job titles?

(A) Teaching art classes
(B) Undercover work
(C) Cooking school lunches
(D) Driving school buses

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: C 4: C 5: C 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Distributed Denial of Secrets: The information came from an entity calling itself the Department of Peace and was harvested from the Okta sign-on service used by DHS.

2. Okta: Its systems are secure and it has no evidence its data or systems were compromised.

3. DHS: It is aware of a breach and is working to address it and protect its employees.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):